

Area of a Circle

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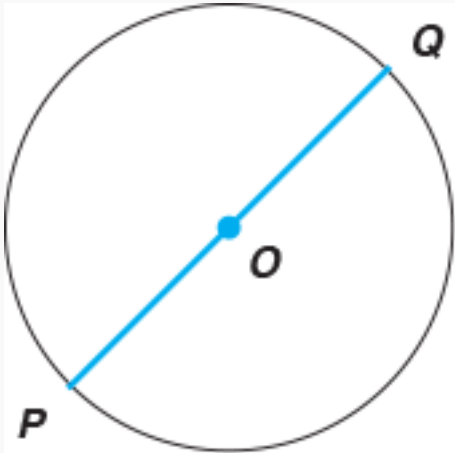
Area of a Circle

The area of a figure is the number of square units it takes to cover a figure. For a circle:

Area (A) of a Circle $A = \pi r^2$, where r = radius

Example

What is the area of a circle when PQ equals 12 inches?



PQ is the diameter: $d = 12$

The radius is half the diameter: $r = 6$

Use the area formula:

$$A = \pi r^2$$

$$\approx 3.14 \cdot 6^2$$

$\approx 3.14 \cdot 36$

≈ 113.04 square inches

Remember that area is measured in square units. Even though you can't fit squares into a circle, you can estimate how many would fit.

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Lesson 3: Circles and Complex Figures

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